

Annual meeting on reporting on climate and energy under the adapted Governance Regulation

The annual project meeting brought together heads of climate change and energy units from relevant ministries and agencies across the Energy Community Contracting Parties that report under the adapted Governance Regulation, alongside representatives of the Energy Community Secretariat, DG ENEST, DG CLIMA, DG ENER, and the EEA. It provided a forum to review progress and challenges in reporting, align stakeholder expectations and priorities for project activities and agree on the workplan for the coming year. The annual project meetings build on and address the conclusions from the previous meetings in order to maximise the support provided.

FROM COPENHAGEN TO TALLINN VIA WARSAW

This was the third annual meeting of the 'Supporting reporting from the Contracting Parties of the Energy Community' project. Together with the regional training workshops, the annual meetings provide a forum for stakeholders to discuss the actions needed to improve the quality and frequency of reporting. After each meeting, the EEA and the Energy Community Secretariat share the outcomes and agreed actions with all stakeholders. The notes below build on the outcomes of the previous two meetings and summarise the conclusions and next steps from the 2026 meeting in Tallinn.

At the first annual meeting, held in Copenhagen in September 2024, the project reviewed initial reporting progress and prepared for the 2025 reporting cycle. The EEA presented its workplan and, through participatory activities, helped develop a tailored plan that responded to the needs of the Contracting Parties. This included webinars, national training sessions in Montenegro, Serbia, Georgia, Moldova, Bosnia and Herzegovina and Kosovo, and regional workshops in Chisinau in December 2024, Vienna in February and December 2025, and in Tirana in April 2025. In addition to strengthening the technical reporting capacity of participating experts, these trainings generated a number of recommendations for improving the reporting process. These were:

- to increase national climate and energy reporting capacity,
- to strengthen inter-institutional cooperation at the national level,
- to integrate the adapted Governance Regulation reporting requirements better in capacity building activities.

The recommendations were translated into in-person and virtual training activities. The preparation for the 2025 cycle resulted in improved reporting rates across dataflows, including both timely and late submissions. The results were due to the dedicated

efforts of the Contracting Parties reporters to prepare and submit reports both before and after the deadlines.

The second annual meeting was held in June 2025 in Warsaw to discuss reporting progress. The meeting led to the following priority focus areas:

- institutional reporting coordination
- IT systems
- technical capacity building
- strategic and political relevance of the reporting exercises

The meeting resulted in a more detailed action plan than in previous years, aimed at better addressing the needs of the Contracting Parties. The EEA's stocktake presentation provides further detail on the agreed actions, their status, and additional steps taken. A summary is included in the section 'Meeting summary – Session per session', and the full presentation was shared by email.

The latest meeting, held in Tallinn, focused on increasing reporting rates and improving data quality. Building on the Warsaw meeting, the outcomes and agreed actions are listed below, building on previous meeting conclusions.

Assessment on national systems for PaMs and projections

Institutional coordination for reporting has improved within the Contracting Parties, but important gaps remain. In particular, weak inter-ministerial coordination continues to hinder effective reporting. To address this, the meeting agreed on the following actions:

- The EEA, in collaboration with the Energy Community Secretariat, has commissioned a report on national systems for PaMs and projections in the Contracting Parties. The report will describe the current status of these systems and provide guidance on how to improve or establish them, building on a similar report prepared for EU Member States. It is expected to be available in late 2026.
 - Contracting Parties are encouraged to engage actively in interview requests for this report.
 - The three Contracting Parties that have not yet submitted their report on national systems for PaMs and projections (Bosnia and Herzegovina, Montenegro and North Macedonia) are encouraged to do so as soon as possible.
- National training sessions help convene stakeholders. The EEA will continue to respond to requests from Contracting Parties for national training.
- The EEA will continue to share lessons learned and best practices in institutional coordination from EU Member States and Contracting Parties through webinars and training sessions.

Technical capacity building

The meeting highlighted the need to strengthen technical capacity, particularly to improve the quality of reporting. In addition, high staff turnover in many Contracting Parties creates a recurring need to train new staff on reporting requirements. On this basis, the following actions were agreed:

- The EEA will continue to offer in-person and virtual capacity-building sessions to the Contracting Parties. These trainings will be tailored to each Contracting Party's specific needs, whether to build reporting capacity, improve the quality of reported information, or both. Please see the workplan for further details.
- The EEA will continue its work to improve data quality based on the quality control (QC) reports for submitted data.
 - o The EEA will provide overarching recommendations in the overall QC summary report to be submitted to the Energy Community Secretariat in late 2026.
- The EEA and the Energy Community Secretariat will develop an online forum for continuous peer exchange among the Contracting Parties which will be launched in autumn 2026.

Strategic and political messaging

The meeting underlined the strategic and political importance of engaging actors at higher administrative and political levels in the Contracting Parties. This is necessary to raise awareness of the reporting process and its links to National Energy and Climate Plans (NECP) planning and implementation. In addition, participants identified a need for better coordination among technical support providers. On this basis, the following actions were agreed:

- The EEA and the Energy Community Secretariat are organising an event at COP31 to showcase how the Contracting Parties can become frontrunners in climate transparency and planning through the adapted Governance Regulation. The event aims to engage high-level speakers from both the EU and the Contracting Parties. Contracting Parties are invited to share information about the event with their COP delegations and through their communication channels.
- The Energy Community Secretariat, with support from the EEA, will explore ways to raise these needs more effectively with the Contracting Parties.

IT systems

Regarding IT systems, the issues identified in previous meetings remain. In particular, internal reporting templates are not always aligned with the reporting requirements of

the adapted Governance Regulation. When possible, these could be aligned to facilitate the reporting process.

- The EEA will continue to develop IT tools to transfer information between the UNFCCC reporting tools and Reportnet, with the aim of facilitating the reporting process.
- The EEA will share factsheets outlining the similarities and differences between the reporting regimes under the adapted Governance Regulation and the Enhanced Transparency Framework under the UNFCCC.
- Contracting Parties are encouraged to share information on their current or planned IT systems relevant to reporting obligations. The EEA will then, where possible, provide comments on their compatibility from both thematic and technical perspectives.